Duality Solo Engine

A d12 game master emulator for solo & GM-less Daggerheart. The Fear pool plays the GM.

How to Play

1. **Frame the scene** you expect, then **test it** (Scene Setup).
2. **Play your character** with the normal rules. Whenever you would ask a GM something, ask the **Oracle**.
3. When you fail or roll with Fear, the engine makes a **GM Move**.
4. When the answer needs inspiration, roll on the **Meaning** tables and interpret the words in context.
5. **End the scene:** update your lists of Threads (open goals) and NPCs. Keep each list to 12 or fewer so a d12 can pick from it.

Always take the first interpretation that makes sense. If nothing fits, the obvious thing happens.

Fear & the Fear Check

Track Fear exactly as the rules say: it grows when you roll with Fear and when you rest, to a maximum of 12. **The engine never invents Fear. It only decides when to spend what you generate.**

Fear Check: roll a d12. If it is **equal to or under current Fear**, the check **passes**: the GM spends Fear and acts. Otherwise it **fails** and the world holds its breath. At 0 Fear it always fails.

The Oracle (Yes / No)

Ask a yes/no question, pick a likelihood, roll your **Hope** and **Fear** dice and add them. Oracle rolls never generate Hope or Fear.

LIKELIHOOD	YES ON	CHANCE
Near certain	7+	90%
Likely	10+	75%
50 / 50	13+	54%
Unlikely	16+	31%
Long shot	19+	15%

Twist: if the dice are **4 or more apart**, add a twist. **Hope higher:** it bends your way (*Yes, and… / No, but…*). **Fear higher:** it bends against you (*Yes, but… / No, and…*). **Doubles:** answer as normal, then a **Random Event** occurs.

How Much? How Well?

D12	RESULT
1–2	Far less than expected: scarce, weak, tiny
3–5	Somewhat less than expected
6–7	About what you would expect
8–10	Somewhat more than expected
11–12	Far more than expected: abundant, mighty, vast

Scene Setup

Describe the scene you expect, then make a **Fear Check**.

- **Fails:** the scene starts as expected.
- **Passes on an odd roll:** spend 1 Fear. The scene is **Altered**: roll below.
- **Passes on an even roll:** spend 1 Fear. The scene is **Interrupted**: a Random Event replaces it.

D12	ALTERED SCENE	SCENE COMPLICATION
1	The place is not as described	Hostile forces oppose you
2	An expected NPC is absent	An obstacle blocks your way
3	An unexpected NPC is present	Wouldn't it be bad if…
4	Someone got here first	An NPC acts suddenly
5	The danger is greater than expected	All is not as it seems
6	The danger is elsewhere, for now	Things actually go as planned
7	Weather, light, or terrain turns	Time is shorter than you thought
8	Something valuable is missing	Innocents are caught in it
9	A countdown is already running	A rival wants the same thing
10	An old Thread intrudes	Your gear or magic misbehaves
11	Remove one element of the scene	The environment turns dangerous
12	Add a Scene Complication	A debt or the past comes due

GM Moves

- **Success with Fear** or **failure with Hope:** Soft Move.
- **Failure with Fear:** **Fear Check**. Pass: spend 1 Fear, Hard Move. Fail: Soft Move.
- **Story stalls** or you hand the world a golden opportunity: Fear Check. Pass: spend 1 Fear, Hard Move.

D12	SOFT MOVE
1	Show how the world reacts
2	Reveal an unwelcome truth
3	Signal a threat approaching off-screen
4	Offer what you want, at a cost
5	Mark a Stress
6	Shift the environment against you
7	An NPC acts on their Motive
8	Tick a countdown
9	Put an item or resource at risk
10	Close off the easy path
11	Your background or a past choice catches up
12	Add a Scene Complication

D12	HARD MOVE (COSTS 1 FEAR)
1	An adversary strikes: take damage
2	A new danger arrives
3	Separate you from an ally or your gear
4	You are captured, pinned, or cornered
5	An opportunity is lost for good
6	Enemy reinforcements arrive
7	Force a choice between two losses
8	A countdown ticks twice
9	Someone or something you care about is harmed
10	Your success is turned against you
11	The environment erupts: collapse, fire, flood
12	Spend 1 more Fear if able: roll twice, both happen

Random Event

Triggered by Oracle doubles or an Interrupted scene. Roll the **Event Focus**, then **Action + Subject** for what happens. For a Thread or NPC, roll a d12 on your list (reroll blanks) or choose.

D12	EVENT FOCUS
1	Something far away changes
2	A strange omen or mystery
3	A new NPC enters
4	A known NPC acts
5	Bad for an NPC
6	Good for an NPC
7	A Thread advances
8	A Thread is set back
9	A Thread closes or transforms
10	Bad for you
11	Good for you
12	The environment acts

Meaning Tables

Roll both Duality Dice. The **Hope die picks the row**; the **Fear die picks the column** (odd = A, even = B). Combine **Action + Subject** for events, **Descriptor + Subject** for things and places.

D12	ACTION A	ACTION B
1	Seek	Deceive
2	Oppose	Abandon
3	Communicate	Betray
4	Move	Pursue
5	Harm	Trap
6	Create	Destroy
7	Reveal	Hide
8	Command	Bargain
9	Take	Release
10	Protect	Delay
11	Assist	Summon
12	Transform	Sacrifice

D12	SUBJECT A	SUBJECT B
1	Enemy	Monster
2	Ally	Stranger
3	Community	Family
4	Home	Ruin
5	Wealth	Weapon
6	Knowledge	Relic
7	Magic	The gods
8	Path	Border
9	Secret	Rumor
10	Oath	Debt
11	Authority	Rebellion
12	Nature	Death

D12	DESCRIPTOR A	DESCRIPTOR B
1	Ancient	Fresh
2	Broken	Massive
3	Hidden	Tiny
4	Sacred	Stolen
5	Cursed	False
6	Wild	Burning
7	Gilded	Frozen
8	Humble	Haunted
9	Strange	Guarded
10	Dangerous	Fragile
11	Beautiful	Powerful
12	Forgotten	Familiar

Adversaries in Combat

When the spotlight passes to the GM, pick the adversary that makes the most sense (or the one that has acted least) and make a **Fear Check**.

- **Fails:** it acts for free. Roll **Tactics**.
- **Passes:** roll **Fear Spend**, pay the cost, resolve it.
- **Chain:** after each GM action, make another Fear Check. On a pass, spend 1 Fear and spotlight another adversary (Tactics). The GM turn ends on the first failed check.

D12	TACTICS (FREE)
1–3	Attack the nearest PC
4–5	Attack the most wounded PC
6	Attack whoever hurt it last
7	Move to a better position; attack if able
8	Use a feature that costs no Fear (else attack)
9	Protect or aid an ally: the leader or the wounded
10	Pursue its own objective and ignore you
11	Hinder: grab, disarm, or impose a condition
12	Act by nature. Below half HP: ask the Oracle if it flees or parleys

D12	FEAR SPEND
1–5	Use a Fear feature, paying its cost (none? attack, then spotlight a second adversary for 1 Fear)
6–8	Attack, then spotlight a second adversary (1 Fear)
9–10	The environment acts: use its Fear feature or a hazard (1 Fear)
11–12	Hard Move: roll on the Hard Move table (1 Fear)

Build encounters with Battle Points as normal. If the engine cannot afford a cost, it rolls Tactics instead.

Generic Generator

For anything else (a room, a relic, a rumor, a town): roll **Descriptor + Subject** for what it is, **Action** for what it does, and **How Much** for its size or strength.

Countdowns

Give every looming threat a countdown die. Soft and Hard Moves tick it; at zero it happens, with no Fear needed. A d12 on your Thread list picks which countdown ticks when it is unclear.

NPC Generator

Roll once per column. Choose ancestry and community to fit the place.

D12	ROLE	MOTIVE
1	Farmer or laborer	Survival
2	Merchant	Wealth
3	Soldier or guard	Protecting loved ones
4	Outlaw	Revenge
5	Priest or devotee	Knowledge
6	Scholar or sage	Power
7	Noble or official	Duty
8	Artisan	Freedom
9	Wanderer or scout	Redemption
10	Spellcaster	Faith
11	Entertainer or trickster	Love
12	Leader or elder	Glory

Attitude is the first reaction. An NPC acting on their own follows their Motive; when unsure, ask the Oracle. **Topic** is what they bring up, ask about, or let slip.

D12	ATTITUDE	QUIRK	TOPIC
1	Hostile	Scarred	A rumor
2	Suspicious	Soft-spoken	Their trouble
3	Suspicious	Boastful	Local rulers
4	Wary	Superstitious	Recent event
5	Wary	Always eating	The past
6	Indifferent	Nervous laugh	A warning
7	Indifferent	Well dressed	A job offer
8	Curious	Hums or sings	NPC gossip
9	Curious	Blunt	The road ahead
10	Friendly	Forgetful	Magic or gods
11	Friendly	Collects oddities	You
12	Eager to help	Hides a secret	A Thread

Plot Hook Generator

Roll once per column. Keep the Twist hidden: reveal it when a Random Event or Hard Move gives it an opening.

D12	OBJECTIVE	OPPOSITION
1	Rescue someone	Bandits or raiders
2	Recover an item	A cult
3	Escort or deliver	A corrupt authority
4	Defend a place	A beast or monster
5	Hunt a creature	Undead or restless spirits
6	Explore the unknown	A rival party
7	Uncover a truth	A mage or witch
8	Stop a ritual or plan	The wilds themselves
9	Broker a peace	A fallen hero
10	Steal or infiltrate	A faction at war
11	Escape or survive	Something from another realm
12	Destroy a threat at its source	Someone you trust

D12	REWARD	TWIST
1	Gold	The patron is lying
2	Rare gear	The victim is willing or guilty
3	A magic relic	A third party interferes
4	A secret or lore	The clock is shorter
5	An ally or favor	The target has moved
6	A safe haven	The enemy is sympathetic
7	Title or standing	It is a trap
8	A debt cleared	The reward is false or cursed
9	A lead on a personal Thread	An old ally stands on the other side
10	Healing or a cure	The real threat is far bigger
11	Passage or access	Success has a moral cost
12	Only doing what is right	It ties to your past

Site Crawler

For dungeons, ruins, and lairs. For each new area roll **Area**, **Exits**, and **Contents**. The first time you roll Area 12, you have found the heart of the site.

D12	AREA	EXITS	CONTENTS
1	Narrow passage	None	Empty; traces only
2	Narrow passage	None	Empty; traces only
3	Open chamber	None	Empty; traces only
4	Open chamber	One	Hazard or trap
5	Crossing or junction	One	Hazard or trap
6	Stairs, drop, or climb	One	Adversaries
7	Collapsed or flooded section	One	Adversaries
8	Living or work quarters	Two	Adversaries guarding treasure
9	Vault or storage	Two	Treasure
10	Shrine or sanctum	Two	An NPC
11	Cavern or overgrowth	Three	A clue to a Thread
12	Heart of the site	Three	Something strange (Meaning)

Journeys

For each leg of travel make a **Fear Check**. **Pass:** spend 1 Fear and roll **Danger**. **Fail:** roll **Discovery**.

D12	DANGER (1 FEAR)	DISCOVERY
1	Ambush	A quiet road; nothing
2	A predator stalks you	Fellow travelers
3	Storm or harsh weather	Shelter or a good campsite
4	The path is lost	A ruin
5	Hazardous crossing	A settlement or homestead
6	Supplies spoiled or lost	A shrine or landmark
7	Hostile patrol	A useful resource
8	Sickness or exhaustion: mark a Stress	Tracks or signs
9	Pursuers catch up	A trader
10	Cursed or haunted ground	Someone in need
11	Natural disaster	A hidden cache
12	The lair of something big	A wondrous sight: gain a Hope

Duality Solo Engine v0.1. Unofficial fan-made play aid for use with Daggerheart; not affiliated with or endorsed by Darrington Press or Critical Role. Design inspired by One Page Solo Engine (Karl Hendricks) and the Mythic Game Master Emulator (Tana Pigeon).